



THE ENGINEERING APPRENTICESHIP REFERENCE

Learn the workflow once. Return to the section you need.

This guide is a task-based reference for students using ETIS Engineering Studio v0.18.1. You do not need to read it front to back. Start with the executive overview, then jump to the task in the index.

STUDIO IS A COACH—NOT A GRADER Use it on unfinished work. The Review Board can challenge evidence and reasoning, but your team owns the engineering decisions and the instructor owns formal course acceptance.

Find the answer you need

- › [I just signed in and do not know where to start](#) · §01–03
- › [What can Studio do for my estimates, architecture, or requirements?](#) · §01 and 05
- › [Where are the two rooms and how do I switch?](#) · §02
- › [How do I link GitHub and verify my team repository?](#) · §04
- › [Which of the three review types should I use?](#) · §05
- › [Who are Maya, Marcus, Elena and Priya?](#) · §06
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- › [I want to return to an old review or review newer work](#) · §11
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Illustrations: green/navy production acceptance screens supplied by the instructor are cropped from the actual v0.18.1 interface. Review numbers, commits and the production-test account are examples. A special snapshot-mismatch figure is explicitly labeled synthetic.



01 | WHAT STUDIO IS FOR

Studio helps you test engineering reasoning against the repository evidence your team has actually pushed. It is useful while work is in progress—not only just before an assignment or phase gate.

Start with the outcome you want

Your goal	Best path	Example you could ask
CHECK OUR PHASE	Board Review	"We are in A2. Where is our plan weakest, and what should we address before implementation?"
CHECK MY DRAFT	Focused Review	"I am developing our Cycle 1 estimates. Are our assumptions, decomposition, testing and integration effort realistic?"
INVESTIGATE A CONCERN	Review Findings	"The board says AI-use verification is not evidenced. Show me what it checked, and what would address this."
DECIDE BETWEEN OPTIONS	Focused Review	"Should we use a database table or event queue for this workflow? Challenge my tradeoffs."
CHECK IMPROVED WORK	Start another review	"We pushed changes. Review the newer repository checkpoint rather than the previous conversation."

What Studio is—and is not

- **Engineering coaching.** Ask questions, inspect sources, test assumptions, argue for alternatives and develop a recommendation. Studio is not an automated grade or an AI authority.
- **Based on repository evidence.** The team must commit and push an artifact for a review to see it. A file existing only on your laptop is invisible to Studio.
- **Developmental, not official submission.** Sakai controls course requirements and deadlines; GitHub records working history; instructor review and required evidence tags remain separate from Studio.

YOU ARE ALLOWED TO BE UNCERTAIN "I don't know" is a good start. Explain what evidence would help you decide. You can ask the reviewer to teach the concept, not merely judge an answer.

02 | TWO ROOMS, ONE WORKFLOW

These are two views of the same engineering learning experience. Use Review Room to talk, then Evidence Room to inspect what the repository supported; return to the conversation as often as needed.

ENGINEERING REVIEW ROOM · DISCUSS	Read the Board's questions; type anything you need to ask; challenge conclusions; form a defensible engineering decision.
ENGINEERING EVIDENCE ROOM · INSPECT	Browse saved phase evidence, cited artifacts, strengths, gaps and REVIEW findings; its latest saved snapshot may differ from a selected older review.

SWITCHING ROOMS IS SAFE The sidebar and the top navigation always let you move between rooms. Once a review is selected, a third paired room switcher appears inside it. Moving between rooms does not end the conversation or change its frozen evidence.

Before selecting a review

A student may see recent review cards without currently viewing a conversation. That is normal. Start a Board Review for a new conversation, or select a previous review from history.

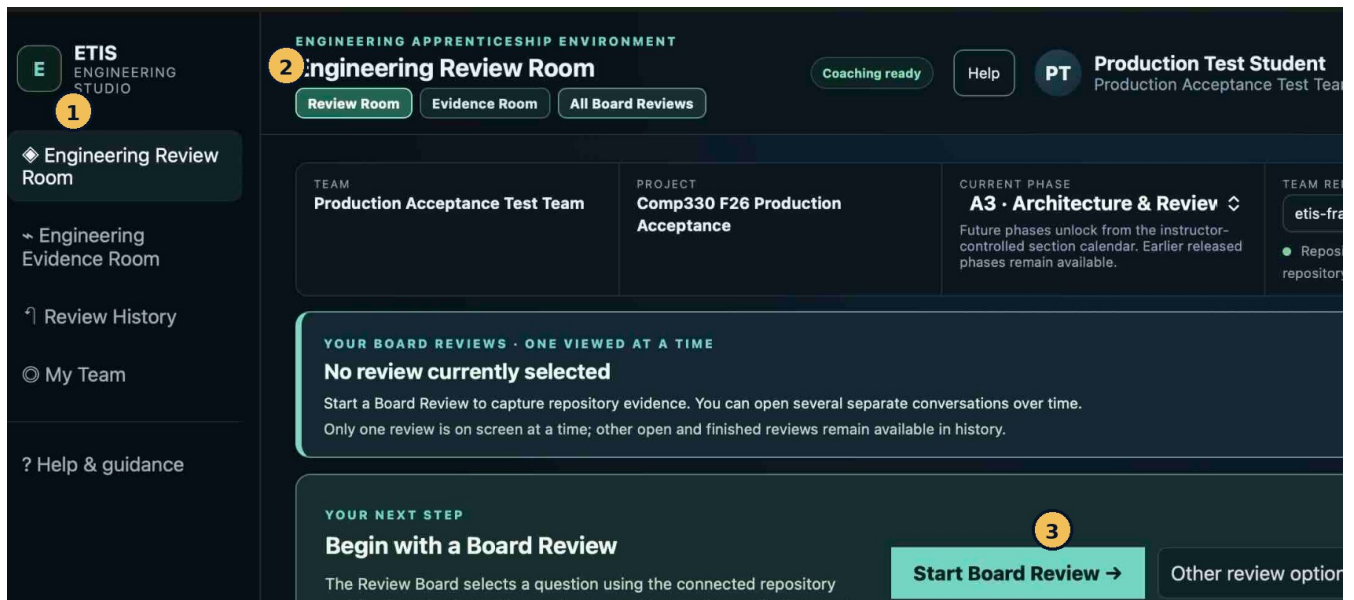


FIGURE 1. Review Room with no review selected. 1 Sidebar rooms · 2 Top room links · 3 Start Board Review.

Evidence Room can also show a previously saved phase snapshot even when no review is selected. Its presence does not start a conversation; “No selected review comparison” simply means no individual review is selected for comparison.

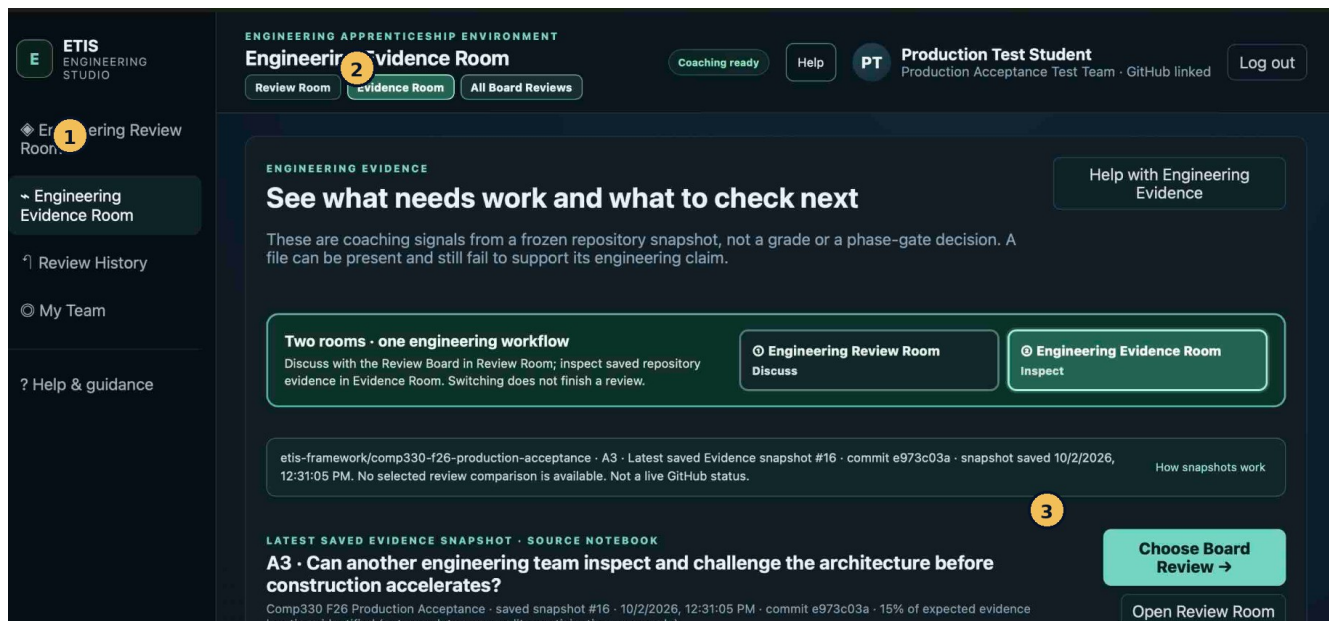


FIGURE 2. Evidence Room, no individual review selected. A previously saved snapshot can still appear with a route back to Review Room.

After selecting a review

The selected review has an ID, phase, status, frozen snapshot and commit. You can move between the rooms using the sidebar, top row or the paired switcher within the review.

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ENGINEERING STUDIO

STUDENT USER GUIDE | COMP 330/474 | v0.18.1

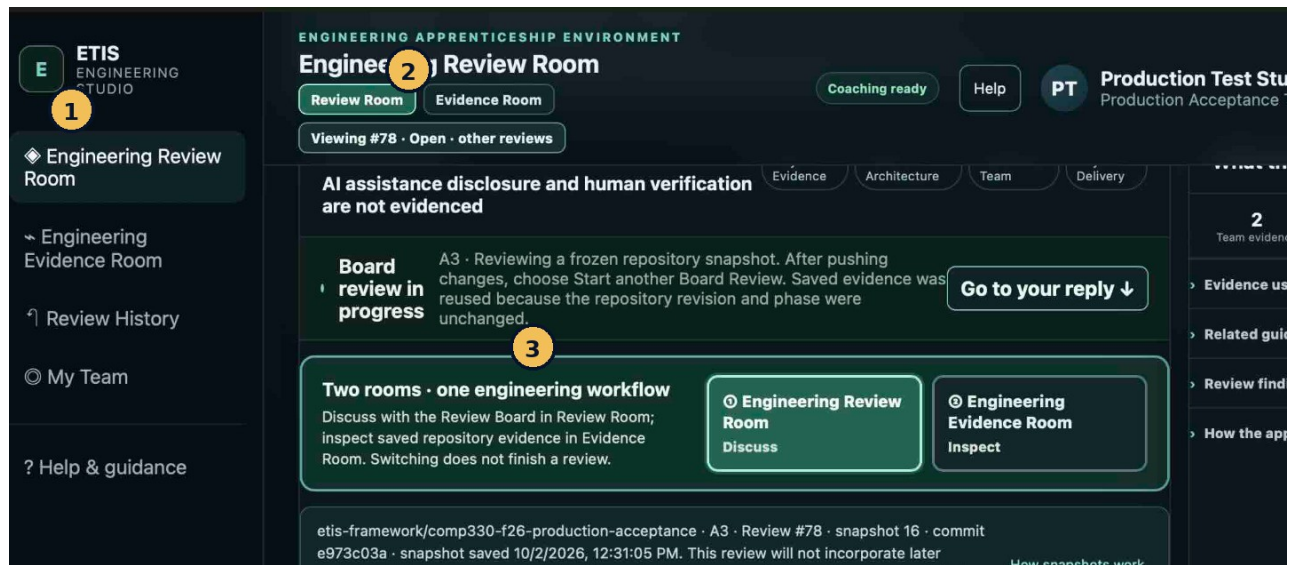


FIGURE 3. Active Review Room. The sidebar, top links and in-review room switcher all reach the same two rooms.

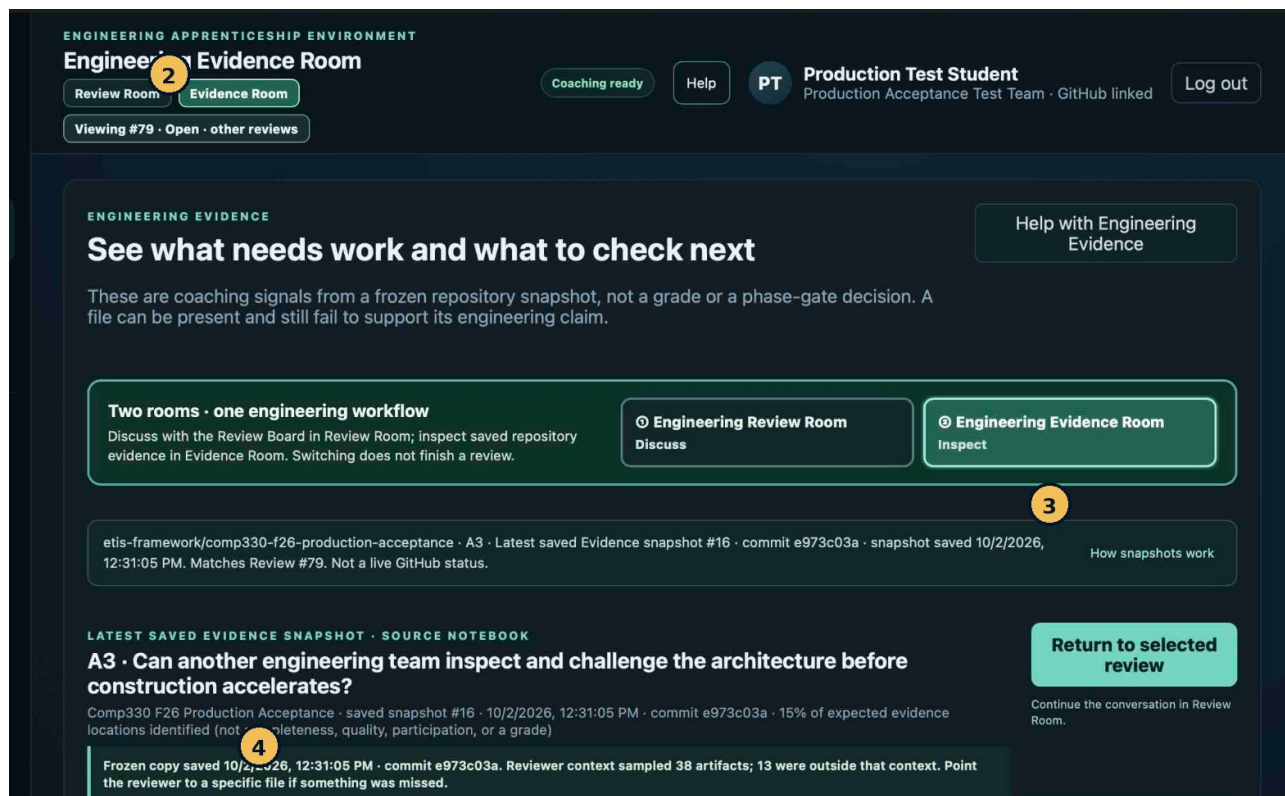


FIGURE 4. Evidence Room with a selected review. Here the saved snapshot matches the review; use Return to selected review to continue the same conversation.

03 | YOUR FIRST FIVE MINUTES

If this is your first visit, make sure Studio recognizes you, knows your team and has the correct team repository. Do not try to begin a review before these independent conditions are ready.

1. Sign in. Open <https://simulator.etisframework.org> and use Loyola sign-in and any required MFA.



2. **Open My Team.** Confirm the correct COMP section and team assignment. A successful sign-in alone does not guarantee course authorization.
3. **Check your GitHub identity.** Link the GitHub username you use for your project. A teammate's account cannot substitute for your own.
4. **Check verified team repository.** If it is already verified and correct, do not nominate it again. Repository trust is shared across teammates.
5. **Open Engineering Review Room.** Check the A1–A6 phase. Choose Start Board Review or Other review options for a narrower intent.

SHARED VERSUS INDIVIDUAL The verified repository and its saved evidence belong to the team context. Your coaching conversations, drafts and developing engineering positions are individual; instructors may have authorized visibility into persisted discussions.

04 | TEAM SETUP AND GITHUB TRUST

My Team distinguishes four separate states: Loyola identity, course/team assignment, your personal GitHub identity and the team's verified repository. A green repository badge does not mean your personal GitHub account is linked.

My Team condition	Meaning
Loyola identity verified	Studio knows your institutional identity.
Course/team assigned	You are authorized in the intended course section and team.
GitHub identity linked	The engineering account you use on GitHub is associated with you; linking is personal.
Verified team repository	The correct team repository was verified through the controlled GitHub App scope; trust is shared.

If your team repository still needs verification

1. **Nominate.** In My Team enter the HTTPS URL of your actual working team repo. This is only a candidate until verified.
2. **Authorize on GitHub.** The personal repository owner or organization owner/admin must grant the required app scope. A student who is not the owner cannot grant this on the owner's behalf.
3. **Restrict scope.** When GitHub asks, choose Only select repositories and select the one nominated team repository. Do not choose All repositories or use a personal access token.
4. **Return and verify.** Click Check & verify repository access in My Team. Authorization alone does not complete verification.
5. **Escalate binding changes.** If an already-verified repository is wrong, contact the instructor/course owner. Students cannot silently replace a trusted team binding.

AVOID DUPLICATE SETUP If you see Verified team repository for the correct project, do not repeat the team onboarding. Link your own GitHub identity if necessary, then proceed to a review.

05 | CHOOSE THE RIGHT REVIEW TYPE

The review type defines the opening purpose, not a permanent list of allowed questions. Start broad with Board Review, narrow with Focused Review or work directly on an existing finding.

BOARD REVIEW

Best when you want a general engineering assessment of the selected phase. The Board chooses the strongest phase-



relevant question based on repository evidence.

EXAMPLE *"We finished a first draft of A2. What assumption or planning gap should our team defend first?"*

WHERE TO START In Review Room choose Start Board Review.

FOCUSED REVIEW

Best when you already know the particular artifact, decision or uncertainty. You choose the focus; the Board coaches that subject. Draft and incomplete files are welcome.

EXAMPLE *"I am writing the Cycle 1 estimates file. Is the task breakdown detailed enough, and what uncertainty or test effort am I missing?"*

WHERE TO START Choose Other review options → Focused Review. Describe the specific subject and start.

REVIEW FINDINGS

Best when Studio has already identified a concern you want explained, challenged, accepted/deferred or resolved. Stay with one to three related findings for a coherent session.

EXAMPLE *"We have an ownership finding. What evidence did you examine, and what would demonstrate a defensible ownership decision?"*

WHERE TO START Choose Other review options → Review Findings and select one to three findings, or use a concern's action in Evidence Room.

YOU CAN CHANGE TOPICS IN ANY REVIEW The initial review purpose is not a conversational straitjacket. A later question about estimates, an architecture choice, or uncertainty is legitimate; the reviewer should follow the new question in the bounds of that frozen snapshot.

06 | MEET THE REVIEW BOARD

Studio presents a small team of AI senior-engineering reviewer personas. They contribute different professional lenses; you are not being graded by four separate people, and you do not need to pick a specific reviewer.



Maya Chen | Evidence Auditor

Clarifies what repository evidence actually supports. Helps distinguish facts, assumptions, missing proof and competing interpretations.



Marcus Reed | Chief Architect

Challenges design boundaries, decision quality, architectural alternatives and downstream consequences.



Elena Torres | Red Team Reviewer

Respectfully stress-tests important assumptions, failure paths and risks once your position is clear enough to challenge.



Priya Nair | Delivery & Planning Lead

Turns choices into realistic tasks, ownership, sequencing, estimates and verification of completion.

These four portrait illustrations come from the actual v0.18.1 Studio repository assets. The live review may feature one reviewer prominently or bring in another perspective when useful; it remains a single student review conversation.

07 | ASK, DISAGREE, CHANGE TOPICS, AND GET COACHING

The Review Room is a conversation, not a quiz. You can interrupt the Board's agenda with any relevant engineering question, request an example, explain what you do not understand, or challenge the reviewer with evidence.



Say what you actually need

- **Change the subject.** "Before I answer your architecture question, can you review our Cycle 1 estimates and the way we calculated them?"
- **Ask for plain-language guidance.** "I do not understand what makes an estimate defensible. Explain with a simple example."
- **Ask what to do next.** "I am stuck. What three things should I inspect or verify before deciding?"
- **Disagree with evidence.** "That finding may be incorrect. We have equivalent evidence in docs/decisions; can you inspect it?"
- **Acknowledge uncertainty.** "I do not know yet. The dependency is unclear and we need a teammate to confirm it."

Conversation controls

Control or approach	When to use it
Talk with the reviewer / Send to Reviewer	Type your own response, new question or change of subject. The reviewer follows the substance of the conversation.
Explain this and show me how	Ask for teaching, a worked example or a smaller next step when you feel stuck.
Build my recommendation	Move toward a structured, defensible engineering recommendation once you have enough information. This is not automatic acceptance.
Find supporting evidence	Ask Studio to search the review's frozen snapshot for other relevant or equivalent support. Results are bounded.
Go to your reply	Return to the composer if you are reading earlier messages farther up the page.

Example: the student changes the conversation

This illustrative exchange shows the intended conversational behavior. It is not a transcript of a real student or a promise that every response uses these exact words.

REVIEW BOARD	"Who owns verification of your Cycle 1 work?"
STUDENT	"Before I answer, could you challenge our draft estimates? I am unsure we included enough testing and integration effort."
NEXT STEP	The Board should address that new question using evidence actually in the selected frozen snapshot, and the student can ask for an explanation or example.



1 REVIEWER QUESTION

MAYA CHEN - EVIDENCE AUDITOR

SENIOR REVIEWER

Let's improve your A3 work before instructor review. Evidence in the repository snapshot used for this review: The AI-use log is an empty baseline table, and the AI policy and verification-notes artifacts are unchanged scaffold. No filled operating record identifies an AI use, human check, modification, or resulting decision. Why it matters: The repository cannot establish whether architecture, diagrams, contracts, decisions, or review preparation received human-verified AI assistance. This is an evidence gap, not proof that AI was used or not used. Check the cited evidence with your team. If I missed something, show me where; otherwise, correct the work and record how you verified it. What should the team do now, given what the repository evidence actually supports?

2 YOUR REPLY AND SEND ACTION

Conversation mode

Talk naturally. Ask a question, respond to the reviewer, or say what you are thinking. The reviewer will respond to the substance—not the button you clicked.

Your turn — reply to Maya

Ask a question, share what your team knows, or say what needs checking. You can disagree.

Talk naturally—ask, answer, disagree, think out loud, or say where you are stuck.

Enter to discuss · Shift+Enter for newline

Write in your own words. Grammar, spelling, and accent are not being graded.

You can answer, ask a question, disagree, or say you are stuck.

Send to Reviewer →

FIGURE 5. Two crops from one production review: the reviewer question (top) and the student reply field with Send to Reviewer (bottom).

NORMAL QUESTIONS ARE WELCOME The Board should respond when you redirect the subject. It is allowed to explain or teach a concept; do not invent evidence or pretend the reviewer approved a deliverable. Grammar, spelling, accent and polished prose are not the engineering objective.

08 | READ AND INSPECT ENGINEERING EVIDENCE

The Evidence Room is a saved source notebook for your selected phase. It helps you see what was found, which claims are supported, where evidence may be thin and which Review Board concerns deserve discussion.

What the Evidence Room is showing

Saved snapshot and commit	Repository provenance for this evidence view; not live GitHub HEAD.
Evidence areas	Phase-specific areas such as architecture, planning, ownership, traceability, or delivery. A count concerns these areas, not total findings.



Review Board findings	Challengeable REVIEW interpretations that may be separate from the evidence-area counters.
Evidence coverage	Fraction of expected/equivalent evidence locations recognized; not completeness, quality, grade or instructor acceptance.
Cited source	An artifact from the frozen evidence snapshot, which you can inspect directly.
Equivalent evidence	A different artifact location or form that fulfills the intended engineering purpose.
Scaffold	Unmodified starter structure. It may help you organize work but does not prove your team completed it.

construction accelerates?

Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance - saved snapshot #16 - 10/2/2026, 12:31:05 PM - commit e973c03a - 15% of expected evidence locations identified (not completeness, quality, participation, or a grade)

Frozen copy saved 10/2/2026, 12:31:05 PM - commit e973c03a. Reviewer context sampled 38 artifacts; 13 were outside that context. Point the reviewer to a specific file if something was missed.

10 Areas needing work or missing 3 Evidence areas with concerns 0 Areas to check or cannot judge 0 Areas with supported claims 17 Separate Review

The first four counts describe 13 evidence areas in this saved snapshot; the 17 Review Board findings are a separate interpretation. Zero evidence-area counts establish that the work is complete or free of concerns.

1

A course concern to examine - Architecture baseline is not evidenced

The supplied architecture artifacts do not establish system purpose, components, responsibilities, dependency direction, interfaces, data boundaries, or Cycle 1 support architecture document and component-responsibilities document remain baseline headings, while the API-contracts document is also unchanged scaffold.

Next: Inspect the cited frozen evidence; ask the reviewer to explain or challenge this interpretation, then decide what to change.

No bounded positive phase claim is established in this snapshot.

This is preparation using the frozen repository snapshot and challengeable REVIEW interpretations. It does not predict an instructor decision or grade. A changed repository needs a new snapshot.

Explore other engineering questions
Optional perspectives on cost, risk, traceability, and more

Browse evidence areas
Open file conditions, frozen sources, and questions about a specific artifact

2

SAVED SNAPSHOT FINDINGS

Questions or concerns worth examining (17 findings)

Findings are the board's interpretations. Find support searches the frozen snapshot for other relevant sources to resolve the concern.

REVIEW UNDER DISCUSSION

Expected evidence not visible: docs/architecture/README.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/architecture/README.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Discuss **Find supporting evidence**

REVIEW OPEN

Expected evidence not visible: docs/architecture/architecture-diagram.png

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/architecture/architecture-diagram.png' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

FIGURE 6. Production Evidence Room details: areas, separate findings, and actions to Discuss or Find supporting evidence. The example illustrates gaps, not a course grade.

ZERO COUNTS ≠ NO CONCERNS The first four counters describe evidence-area conditions; a separate finding count may be nonzero. Evidence percentages do not predict grades. Missing attributable activity is not proof of individual nonparticipation.

09 | WORK WITH A FINDING OR SUSPECTED ERROR

Review findings are interpretations of frozen FACT. They should be investigated, not automatically accepted. A good challenge identifies a source, explains what it establishes and respects the snapshot boundary.

Action	Purpose
Discuss	Ask what the concern means and why it matters.



Action	Purpose
Inspect cited source	View the original frozen file tied to the concern.
Find supporting evidence	Search for related/equivalent evidence in the same saved snapshot.
Challenge	Present counterevidence or explain why the interpretation does not follow.
Help me resolve this	Get concrete next steps for improving or verifying the engineering work.
Accept / defer	Recognize a risk or postpone work with rationale, ownership and conditions to revisit.

What actually closes a finding?

A finding closes only after an authorized correction or resolution. Discussion, searching, accepting a risk, deferring work, finishing a review or pushing later commits does not automatically close the finding attached to the old snapshot.

If an artifact existed at the checkpoint but Studio missed it, cite the equivalent source and challenge the REVIEW interpretation. If your team created or corrected the artifact after the checkpoint, leave the old evidence intact and start another review for the newer repository revision.

FACT VERSUS REVIEW FACT: frozen repository-derived observations. REVIEW: professional interpretation of those observations. REVIEW can be challenged, disputed or corrected; FACT cannot be quietly backfilled by later work.

10 | FORM A DEFENSIBLE ENGINEERING RECOMMENDATION

You may explore a question for several turns before you are ready to decide. A current recommendation describes where you are leaning; it is optional and can change as you learn.

Possible posture	What it communicates
Not ready yet	Identify the missing evidence, authority or uncertainty preventing a responsible decision.
Continue	Proceed with the current approach and explain its supporting evidence.
Continue with conditions	Proceed under explicit safeguards, triggers and ownership.
Hold / defer	Pause the relevant decision or work until a defined uncertainty is reduced.
Reject this path	Explain a better direction and why the present one is unacceptable.
Request evidence / escalate	Ask for information or authorization beyond your present evidence or authority.

A strong recommendation answers seven questions

1. What are you recommending—or why are you not ready?
2. Which repository evidence supports the position?
3. What uncertainty or evidence boundary remains?
4. What risk and tradeoff are you accepting?
5. Which constraints or guardrails must hold?
6. Who owns the implementation or verification?
7. What would cause you to change, reject, lift, or close the decision?

The Build my recommendation action helps structure the reasoning. “Discuss Recommendation” sends reasoning while in recommendation mode; a separate State My Recommendation action records a defended position when appropriate. None of these actions submits your phase gate or automatically closes a finding.



11 | MULTIPLE REVIEWS, SNAPSHOTS, AND HISTORY

Reviews accumulate. Only one session is selected on screen, but several can remain Open. Each conversation stays attached to the repository evidence that was frozen when that session began.

Term	Student meaning
CURRENTLY VIEWING	The one review you have selected in Studio now; not necessarily the newest or only Open review.
OPEN	Resumable conversation against the original frozen evidence. It does not absorb later commits.
FINISHED	Read-only historical conversation and its original evidence. Finishing does not erase it or imply instructor approval.
REVIEW HISTORY	Your chronological record of individual engineering conversations; open or finished reviews can be selected for reading.
GITHUB HISTORY	The authoritative place for commits, branch/PR/tag history and exact changed lines.

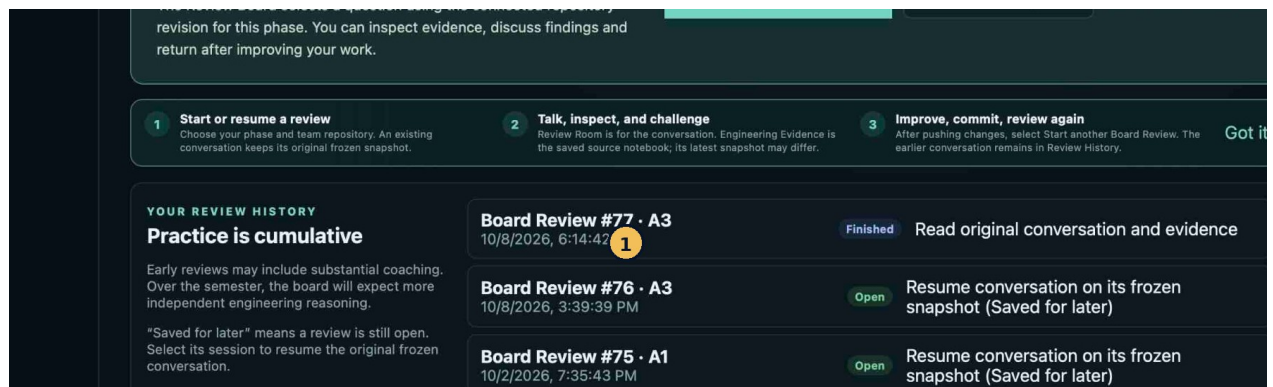


FIGURE 7. Production landing-page review history. Earlier conversations can exist even when no review is currently selected.

Understand the two snapshot labels

- **Selected review snapshot.** Fixed checkpoint used by the currently selected conversation; it never silently updates to newer GitHub commits.
- **Latest saved Evidence Room snapshot.** Saved phase notebook displayed in Evidence Room; it can differ from your selected review's snapshot.
- **If different.** Studio should warn you. Use the selected review's original evidence controls to avoid arguing from information that was not present at its checkpoint.

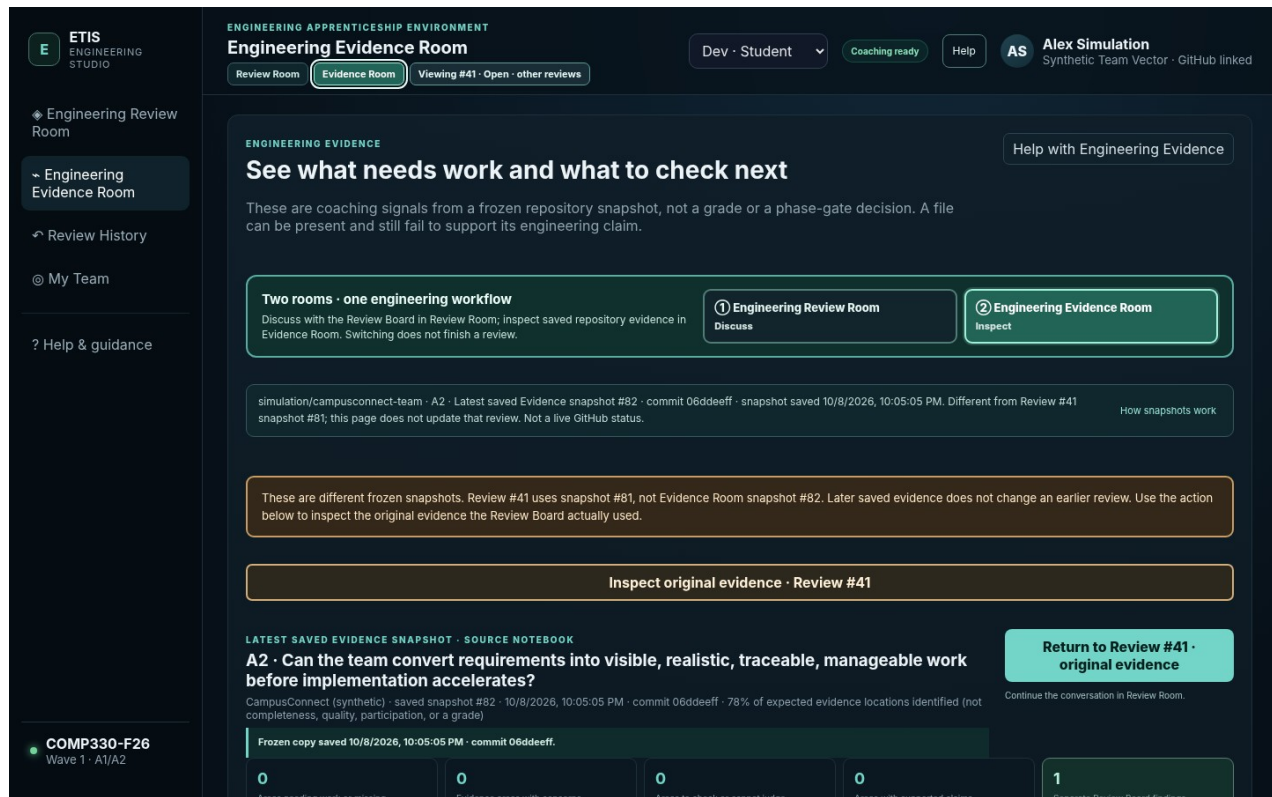


FIGURE 8. Synthetic v0.18.1 mismatch demonstration (not live student data): the selected older review has different evidence from the latest saved Evidence Room snapshot.

STARTING ANOTHER REVIEW After committing and pushing changes, select Start another Board Review or another suitable review purpose. A new conversation can still reuse a snapshot when phase and commit are unchanged—check the displayed commit and snapshot ID.

12 | COMPLETE EXAMPLE: REVIEW → IMPROVE → REVIEW AGAIN

Follow this end-to-end example at your own pace. It demonstrates the same steps for an A2 estimate, A3 architecture artifact or a later phase's release evidence.

- 1. Open My Team.** Confirm correct class/team; link your GitHub identity; make sure the team repository is verified.
- 2. Push your draft.** Commit the estimates/plan/architecture files you want reviewed. Reviewers cannot inspect unsaved local-only work.
- 3. Choose phase and purpose.** Review Room → current A1–A6 phase → Start Board Review for broad feedback or Other review options → Focused Review for a particular file.
- 4. Specify the engineering question.** For Focused Review, describe the estimate assumptions, breakdown, ownership, dependencies, uncertainty and verification you want challenged.
- 5. Read the selected review context.** Check the review number, Open status, commit and frozen snapshot. One displayed conversation does not mean there is only one session.
- 6. Ask and redirect freely.** Respond naturally. Ask for examples; change the topic to another concern; request “Explain this and show me how” if you get stuck.
- 7. Inspect evidence.** Move to Evidence Room and view the relevant saved source. Match the selected review's snapshot or return to its original evidence controls if they differ.



8. **Decide what to improve.** Challenge unsupported interpretations or agree on a concrete engineering improvement and how to verify it.
9. **Make the repository change.** Work with your team; update files; review PRs/tests as appropriate; commit and push the result.
10. **Begin another review.** Use Start another Board Review or a suitable new Focused Review. Confirm the new commit/snapshot; do not assume a new session automatically includes new commits.
11. **Compare and preserve history.** Review History → open the earlier conversation; resume only if Open, read if Finished. Nothing you did later backfills the older checkpoint.
12. **Finish intentionally.** Choose Finish this review when you are done discussing. The session remains available read-only and is not course phase-gate acceptance.

PRACTICAL ESTIMATES PROMPT "I am still developing docs/planning/estimates. Check whether the work is decomposed enough, whether assumptions and uncertainties are clear, and whether we included testing, integration, dependencies and ownership. What should we address next?"

13 | HELP, PRIVACY, AND SAFE RECOVERY

Navigation Help and engineering coaching serve different purposes. Use Help for interface instructions; use the Review Room to ask substantive engineering questions without needing to wait for an instructor demonstration.

Where to get assistance

Help / Help & guidance	Navigation, room definitions, review lifecycle and problem reporting. Routine help does not call a paid AI reviewer.
Explain this and show me how	In-review teaching and engineering coaching from the Board.
Help me resolve this	Finding-specific coaching on improving work or gathering evidence.
Course instructor / support	Authorization, roster assignment, repository reset and persistent technical failures requiring staff access.

What is shared and what stays individual

Team-shared	Team membership/project context, verified repository, frozen team evidence and repository-derived findings.
Student-specific	Review conversations and history, evolving recommendations, linked personal GitHub identity and unsent drafts.
Instructor visibility	Authorized staff can inspect persisted review turns for teaching oversight. This does not turn conversation counts into grades or authorize the AI to assign participation.
Draft privacy	Unsent text is retained with its original review/browser session where supported; avoid assuming cross-device synchronization of unsubmitted work.

If an action fails

1. **Check what saved.** If review start failed, look at Review History before retrying. If sending failed, look at the conversation to see whether the turn already appeared.
2. **Protect your draft.** Return to the original review and browser tab. Copy critical unsent work if necessary before refreshing or signing out.
3. **Retry deliberately.** Avoid repeated clicks. Confirm the selected review and snapshot context before resubmitting the logical action.



4. Report safely. Tell the instructor the phase, approximate time, clicked action and error message. Do not include tokens, secrets or private transcripts in public reports.

Within Help, artifact, challenge and exit dialogs, Tab/Shift+Tab move among controls; Escape normally dismisses through the dialog's close path and does not finish a review. A challenge request already sent may still complete even if you close its dialog.

14 | TROUBLESHOOTING QUICK LOOKUP

Use the symptom to find the next safe step. If the problem concerns repository authorization, distinguish your personal GitHub identity from the team-wide verified repository.

Can sign in, but course unavailable	Authentication is not roster authorization. Verify your course/section assignment; contact the instructor if it is wrong.
GitHub account is wrong	My Team → Change linked GitHub account; link the engineering account you actually use.
Repo owner authorization needed	Have the personal repo owner or GitHub organization owner/admin authorize; do not try random credentials.
GitHub App asks which repositories	Select Only select repositories and only the nominated team repository. Never select All repositories.
GitHub authorization done; still not verified	Return to My Team and choose Check & verify repository access.
Repository is already verified	Do not repeat onboarding. Ensure your own personal GitHub identity is linked and start your review.
Evidence thin or low percentage	Check for unmodified starter scaffold, missing team-created artifacts or equivalent evidence elsewhere. Coverage is not a grade.
Board missed an artifact	Challenge with the path and engineering rationale; use Find supporting evidence against the same frozen snapshot.
I pushed a change; the review still seems old	Expected: it is frozen. Start another review to capture/reuse the currently available repository revision.
I cannot type in a Finished review	Expected: finished conversations are read-only. Return to an Open review or start another.
A response failed or seems duplicated	Inspect Review History/current conversation first; do not repeatedly send an uncertain turn.
Page repeatedly slow or broken	Retry carefully; use Help, and provide a minimal reproducible report to staff without disclosing secrets.



15 | GLOSSARY AND EVIDENCE BOUNDARIES

These definitions help interpret Studio without confusing developmental coaching, GitHub history and formal course acceptance.

FACT	Immutable repository-derived evidence at the selected frozen checkpoint.
REVIEW	A challengeable judgment about that evidence; it may be discussed, disputed or corrected.
Evidence snapshot / checkpoint	Saved repository evidence package associated with a review, including relevant bounded repository metadata.
Current review	The one individual session currently on screen. Others may remain Open or Finished.
Current recommendation	An optional, revisable decision posture; not the same as a formally stated final recommendation.
Equivalent evidence	Different file or artifact form that accomplishes the required engineering purpose.
Starter scaffold	Provided initial template or example not by itself attributable to the team's completed work.
Preflight / formal phase gate	Separate course-controlled submission/assessment process governed by the official evidence boundary.
Review findings	Board concerns bound to the evidence context under which they were generated; not proof of individual nonparticipation.
Review History vs. GitHub history	Review History stores conversations/snapshot contexts; GitHub stores exact source-control events.

THE THREE RESOURCES Start Here = one-page orientation. Cheat Sheet = desk-side working reference. This User Guide = step-by-step, searchable explanations and screenshots. You can return to any section as needed.

Thirty-second check before a new review

- **What will be reviewed?** Check the team repository, selected course phase and specific concern.
- **Is the work in GitHub?** Commit and push the file or code you want Studio to see.
- **Is this a new session or an old one?** Resuming an Open review uses old frozen evidence; a new review may capture a newer commit.
- **Am I asking the right question?** Board Review for phase-level coaching; Focused Review for a specific concern; Review Findings for existing findings.
- **How will I verify a suggestion?** Inspect cited sources and challenge interpretation where necessary; decide what to change yourself.

Useful opening questions

Estimate or plan	"Which estimates or dependencies are least defensible, and what evidence or decomposition would improve them?"
Architecture decision	"What boundary or tradeoff are we overlooking, and what failure path should we test?"
Finding challenge	"Which frozen evidence produced this finding? Did you consider the equivalent artifact at another path?"
When stuck	"Please explain the engineering issue in simpler language and give me a first verification step."